Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Laboratory – Hepatitis Testing

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: LAB2023002
Published date: 03/2023
Revision date: 04/2026

Disclaimer: *The intended audience of this medical claims payment policy is healthcare providers who treat Humana members. This policy is made available to provide information on certain Humana claims payment policies. This policy is a guideline only and does not constitute medical advice, guarantee of payment, plan pre-authorization, an explanation of benefits, or a contract. This policy does not govern whether a procedure is covered under a specific member plan or policy, nor is it intended to address every claim situation. Claims may be affected by other factors, such as: state and federal laws and regulations, provider contract terms, and our professional judgment. This policy is subject to change or termination by Humana. Humana has full and final discretionary authority for its interpretation and application. No part of this policy may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted, in any shape or form or by any means, electronic, mechanical, photocopying or otherwise without express written permission from Humana. When printed, this version becomes uncontrolled. For the most current information, always refer to the following website:* ***Humana.com/ClaimPaymentPolicies***

Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

As a Medicare Advantage plan, we have developed payment policies to explain coverage more fully for services. The criteria outlined will apply to Medicare Advantage plans except when the procedure(s) has established criteria through the Original Medicare National Coverage Determinations (NCDs) and Local Coverage Determinations (LCDs) as outlined below.

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

- For individuals with a confirmed diagnosis of hepatitis B virus (HBV), testing for Immunoglobulin M antibody to hepatitis B core antigen (IgM anti-HBc) (CPT code 86705) or for HBV deoxyribonucleic acid (DNA) (CPT code 87516, CPT code 87517) **IS REIMBURSABLE**.
- Antibody testing for hepatitis C virus (HCV) infection (CPT code 86803, CPT code 86804) **IS REIMBURSABLE** in any of the following situations**:**
  - For screening in pregnant individuals
  - Once per lifetime for all individuals over 18 years of age
  - One test every 90 days for any individual with recognized conditions or exposures in any of the following situations:
    - Children born from an HCV-positive individual
    - Current sexual partners of HCV-infected persons
    - Evidence of liver disease
    - History of incarceration
    - History of or current hemodialysis
    - Illicit drug use
    - Illicit intranasal
    - Injectable drug use
    - Presence of human immunodeficiency virus (HIV) infection
    - Receipt of a blood transfusion or blood component
    - Receipt of a tattoo
    - Receipt of an organ transplant
- Testing for HCV genotype (CPT code 87902) **IS REIMBURSABLE** with a confirmed diagnosis of HCV.
- Qualitative nucleic acid testing for HCV ribonucleic acid (CPT code 87520, CPT code 87521) **IS REIMBURSABLE:**
  - With a confirmed diagnosis of HCV: up to 12 tests per year
  - As a one-time screen for perinatally exposed infants who are less than one year of age

- Quantitative nucleic acid testing for HCV viral load (CPT code 87522) **IS REIMBURSABLE** once per month not to exceed seven tests in 18 months.
- For individuals who have tested negative for HBV and HCV, antibody testing for hepatitis A virus (HAV) (CPT code 86708, CPT code 86709) **IS REIMBURSABLE.**
- For individuals who have tested positive for HBV, antibody testing for hepatitis D virus (HDV) (CPT code 86692, CPT code 87380) **IS REIMBURSABLE.**

Applicable procedures for Medicare Advantage plans

Procedure code	Code description
86692	Antibody, hepatitis, delta agent
86705	Hepatitis B core antibody (HBcAb); IgM antibody
86708	Hepatitis A antibody (HAAb)
86709	Hepatitis A antibody (HAAb), IgM antibody
86803	Hepatitis C antibody
86804	Hepatitis C antibody; confirmatory test (eg, immunoblot)
87380	Infectious agent antigen detection by immunoassay technique, (eg, enzyme immunoassay [EIA], enzyme-linked immunosorbent assay [ELISA], fluorescence immunoassay [FIA], immunochemiluminometric assay [IMCA]) qualitative or semiquantitative; hepatitis, delta agent
87516	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis B virus, amplified probe technique
87517	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis B virus, quantification
87520	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis C, direct probe technique
87521	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis C, amplified probe technique, includes reverse transcription when performed
87522	Infectious agent detection by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis C, quantification, includes reverse transcription when performed
87902	Infectious agent genotype analysis by nucleic acid (DNA or RNA); hepatitis C virus

References

AASLD. Don't repeat hepatitis C virus (HCV) antibody testing in patients with a previous positive (HCV) test. Instead, order hepatitis C viral load testing for assessment of active versus resolved infection. https://www.aafp.org/pubs/afp/collections/choosing-wisely/420.html

AASLD-IDSA. HCV in Pregnancy. Updated December 19, 2023. https://www.hcvguidelines.org/unique-populations/pregnancy

AASLD-IDSA. HCV Testing and Linkage to Care. Updated October 24, 2022. https://www.hcvguidelines.org/evaluate/testing-and-linkage

AASLD-IDSA. Hepatitis C guidance: AASLD-IDSA recommendations for testing, managing, and treating adults infected with hepatitis C virus. *Hepatology*. 2015/09/01 2015;62(3):932-954. doi:10.1002/hep.27950

AASLD-IDSA. Management of Acute Infection. Updated October 24, 2022. https://www.hcvguidelines.org/sites/default/files/full-guidance-pdf/AASLD-IDSA_HCVGuidance_October_24_2022.pdf

AASLD-IDSA. Monitoring Patients Who Are Starting HCV Treatment, Are on Treatment, or Have Completed Therapy. Updated December 19, 2023. https://www.hcvguidelines.org/evaluate/monitoring

Abbott. Bioline™ HCV. https://www.globalpointofcare.abbott/ww/en/product-details/bioline-hcv.html

Abbott. RealTime HCV viral load. https://www.molecular.abbott/int/en/products/infectious-disease/realtime-hcv-viral-load

Ansaldi F, Orsi A, Sticchi L, Bruzzone B, Icardi G. Hepatitis C virus in the new era: perspectives in epidemiology, prevention, diagnostics and predictors of response to therapy. *World J Gastroenterol*. Aug 7 2014;20(29):9633-52. doi:10.3748/wjg.v20.i29.9633

Bailey JR, Barnes E, Cox AL. Approaches, Progress, and Challenges to Hepatitis C Vaccine Development. *Gastroenterology*. Jan 2019;156(2):418-430. doi:10.1053/j.gastro.2018.08.060

Bhattacharya D, Aronsohn A, Price J, Lo Re V. Hepatitis C Guidance 2023 Update: AASLD-IDSA Recommendations for Testing, Managing, and Treating Hepatitis C Virus Infection. *Clin Infect Dis*. May 25 2023;doi:10.1093/cid/ciad319

BioMérieux. VIDAS® Hepatitis panel. https://www.biomerieux.com/corp/en/our-offer/clinical-products/vidas-hepatitis-panel.html
Bixler D, Barker L, Lewis K, Peretz L, Teshale E. Prevalence and awareness of Hepatitis B virus infection in the United States: January 2017 - March 2020. *Hepatol Commun*. Apr 1 2023;7(4)doi:10.1097/hc9.0000000000000118
Brunetto MR, Ricco G, Negro F, et al. EASL Clinical Practice Guidelines on hepatitis delta virus. *J Hepatol*. Aug 2023;79(2):433-460. doi:10.1016/j.jhep.2023.05.001
Catlett B, Bajis S, Starr M, et al. Evaluation of the Aptima HCV Quant Dx Assay for Hepatitis C Virus RNA Detection from Fingerstick Capillary Dried Blood Spot and Venepuncture-Collected Samples. *J Infect Dis*. Mar 3 2021;223(5):818-826. doi:10.1093/infdis/jiaa442
CDC. 2024 National Viral Hepatitis Progress Report. Updated December 5, 2024. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis/php/npr-2024/index.html
CDC. Clinical Overview of Hepatitis A. Updated January 11, 2024. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis-a/hcp/clinical-overview/
CDC. Clinical Overview of Hepatitis C. Updated January 31, 2025. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis-c/hcp/clinical-overview/
CDC. Clinical Screening and Diagnosis for Hepatitis A. Updated January 11, 2024. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis-a/hcp/diagnosis-testing/index.html
CDC. Clinical Screening and Diagnosis for Hepatitis C. Updated January 31, 2025. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis-c/hcp/diagnosis-testing/
CDC. Clinical Testing and Diagnosis for Hepatitis B. Updated January 31, 2025. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis-b/hcp/diagnosis-testing/
CDC. Establishing a Road Map for Accelerated Diagnosis and Treatment of HCV Infection in the United States. Updated January 8, 2025. https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/01/08/2025-00204/establishing-a-road-map-for-accelerated-diagnosis-and-treatment-of-hcv-infection-in-the-united
CDC. Hepatitis C Surveillance. The Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. Updated October 9, 2024. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis-surveillance-2022/hepatitis-c/
CDC. Hepatitis D Basics. Updated April 24, 2024. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis-d/about/index.html
CDC. Hepatitis D Virus 2025 Case Definition. Updated September 13, 2024. https://ndc.services.cdc.gov/case-definitions/hepatitis-d-virus-hdv/
CDC. Recommendations for the Identification of Chronic Hepatitis C Virus Infection Among Persons Born During 1945–1965. https://www.cdc.gov/mmwr/preview/mmwrhtml/rr6104a1.htm
CDC. Screening and Testing for Hepatitis B Virus Infection: CDC Recommendations — United States, 2023. Updated March 10, 2023. https://www.cdc.gov/mmwr/volumes/72/rr/rr7201a1.htm
CDC. Surveillance for Viral Hepatitis – United States, 2018. 2018;
CDC. Testing and Clinical Management of Health Care Personnel Potentially Exposed to Hepatitis C Virus — CDC Guidance, United States, 2020. https://www.cdc.gov/mmwr/volumes/69/rr/rr6906a1.htm
CDC. The ABCs of Hepatitis – for Health Professionals. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis/resources/professionals/pdfs/ABCTable.pdf
CDC. Updated Operational Guidance for Implementing CDC's Recommendations on Testing for Hepatitis C Virus Infection. Updated July 14, 2023. https://www.cdc.gov/mmwr/volumes/72/wr/mm7228a2.htm
CDC. Viral Hepatitis Exposure Risk Among Health Care Providers. Updated May 14, 2024. https://www.cdc.gov/hepatitis/hcp/populations-settings/health-care-providers.html
Cepheid. Xpert® HCV. https://www.cepheid.com/en-US/tests/blood-virology-womens-health-sexual-health/xpert-hcv.html
Chen Y, Ji H, Shao J, et al. Different Hepatitis C Virus Infection Statuses Show a Significant Risk of Developing Type 2 Diabetes Mellitus: A Network Meta-Analysis. *Dig Dis Sci*. Nov 23 2019;doi:10.1007/s10620-019-05918-7
Chevaliez S, Wlassow M, Volant J, et al. Assessing Molecular Point-of-Care Testing and Dried Blood Spot for Hepatitis C Virus Screening in People Who Inject Drugs. *Open forum infectious diseases*. Jun 2020;7(6):ofaa196. doi:10.1093/ofid/ofaa196
Chopra S, Arora S. Patient evaluation and selection for antiviral therapy for chronic hepatitis C virus infection. Updated Jan 23, 2025. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/patient-evaluation-and-selection-for-antiviral-therapy-for-chronic-hepatitis-c-virus-infection
Chopra S, Arora S. Screening and diagnosis of chronic hepatitis C virus infection. Updated Jan 29, 2025. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/screening-and-diagnosis-of-chronic-hepatitis-c-virus-infection
Chopra S, Pockros PJ. Overview of the management of chronic hepatitis C virus infection. Updated April 5, 2024. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/overview-of-the-management-of-chronic-hepatitis-c-virus-infection

Chopra S. Clinical manifestations and natural history of chronic hepatitis C virus infection. Updated February 7, 2024. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/clinical-manifestations-and-natural-history-of-chronic-hepatitis-c-virus-infection

Diagnostics M. Truenat ® HCV. https://www.molbiodiagnostics.com/truenat-assays/?des=hbv#assaysSec

EASL. EASL recommendations on treatment of Hepatitis C 2020. 2020;

Faisal Ali MN, Ruben Hernaez, Daniel Huang, Julius Wilder, Alejandro Piscoya, Tracey Simon, and Yngve Falck-Ytter Prevention and treatment of hepatitis B reactivation. Updated January 23, 2025. https://gastro.org/clinical-guidance/guideline-update-for-hepatitis-b-reactivation/

FDA. FDA Permits Marketing of First Point-of-Care Hepatitis C RNA Test. Updated June 27, 2024. https://www.fda.gov/news-events/press-announcements/fda-permits-marketing-first-point-care-hepatitis-c-rna-test

Ghany MG, Morgan TR. Hepatitis C Guidance 2019 Update: American Association for the Study of Liver Diseases-Infectious Diseases Society of America Recommendations for Testing, Managing, and Treating Hepatitis C Virus Infection. *Hepatology*. Feb 2020;71(2):686-721. doi:10.1002/hep.31060

Harvey L, Jacka B, Bazerman L, et al. Feasibility and Performance of a Point-of-Care Hepatitis C RNA Assay in a Community Supervision Cohort. *JAMA Network Open*. 2024;7(10):e2438222-e2438222. doi:10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2024.38222

IHS. Hepatitis C and Tuberculosis Screening. https://www.ihs.gov/diabetes/clinician-resources/soc/hepc-tb-screening/

IHS. Infectious Diseases. https://www.ihs.gov/opioids/harmreduction/infectiousdiseases/

Inoue J, Kanno A, Wakui Y, et al. Identification of Genotype 2 HCV in Serotype-1 Hepatitis C Patients Unresponsive to Daclatasvir plus Asunaprevir Treatment. *The Tohoku journal of experimental medicine*. Jan 2017;241(1):21-28. doi:10.1620/tjem.241.21

Jacobson IM, Lim JK, Fried MW. American Gastroenterological Association Institute Clinical Practice Update-Expert Review: Care of Patients Who Have Achieved a Sustained Virologic Response After Antiviral Therapy for Chronic Hepatitis C Infection. *Gastroenterology*. May 2017;152(6):1578-1587. doi:10.1053/j.gastro.2017.03.018

JMitra&Co. HCV TRI-DOT. https://jmitra.co.in/product-details/hcv-tri-dot-rapid-test-kit/

Kanwal F, Bacon BR, Beste LA, et al. Hepatitis C Virus Infection Care Pathway - A Report From the American Gastroenterological Association Institute HCV Care Pathway Work Group. *Gastroenterology*. 2017;152(6):1588-1598. doi:10.1053/j.gastro.2017.03.039

Keles E, Hassan-Kadle MA, Osman MM, et al. Clinical characteristics of acute liver failure associated with hepatitis A infection in children in Mogadishu, Somalia: a hospital-based retrospective study. *BMC Infect Dis*. Aug 30 2021;21(1):890. doi:10.1186/s12879-021-06594-7

Krist AH, Davidson KW, Mangione CM, et al. Screening for Hepatitis B Virus Infection in Adolescents and Adults: US Preventive Services Task Force Recommendation Statement. *Jama*. Dec 15 2020;324(23):2415-2422. doi:10.1001/jama.2020.22980

Lai M, Chopra S. Hepatitis A virus infection in adults: Epidemiology, clinical manifestations, and diagnosis. Updated Dec 12, 2024. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/hepatitis-a-virus-infection-in-adults-epidemiology-clinical-manifestations-and-diagnosis

Lampertico P, Agarwal K, Berg T, et al. EASL 2017 Clinical Practice Guidelines on the management of hepatitis B virus infection. *Journal of Hepatology*. 2017/08/01/ 2017;67(2):370-398. doi:10.1016/j.jhep.2017.03.021

Langan RC, Goodbred AJ. Hepatitis A. *Am Fam Physician*. Oct 1 2021;104(4):368-374.

Lexidrug. Ledipasvir and sofosbuvir: Drug information. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/ledipasvir-and-sofosbuvir-drug-information

Linthicum MT, Gonzalez YS, Mulligan K, et al. Value of expanding HCV screening and treatment policies in the United States. *The American journal of managed care*. May 2016;22(6 Spec No.):Sp227-35.

Lok AS. Hepatitis B virus: Overview of management. Updated Sep 10, 2024. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/hepatitis-b-virus-overview-of-management

Muir AJ, Graham CS. Management of chronic hepatitis C virus infection: Initial antiviral therapy in adults. Updated January 24, 2024. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/management-of-chronic-hepatitis-c-virus-infection-initial-antiviral-therapy-in-adults

OraSure. OraQuick® HCV test https://orasure.com/products/OraQuick-HCV.html

Owens DK, Davidson KW, Krist AH, et al. Screening for Hepatitis C Virus Infection in Adolescents and Adults: US Preventive Services Task Force Recommendation Statement. *Jama*. Mar 2 2020;doi:10.1001/jama.2020.1123

Qiu S, Cai J, Yang Z, et al. Trends in Hepatocellular Carcinoma Mortality Rates in the US and Projections Through 2040. *JAMA Network Open*. 2024;7(11):e2445525-e2445525. doi:10.1001/jamanetworkopen.2024.45525

Razavi H, Waked I, Sarrazin C, et al. The present and future disease burden of hepatitis C virus (HCV) infection with today's treatment paradigm. *Journal of viral hepatitis*. May 2014;21 Suppl 1:34-59. doi:10.1111/jvh.12248

Reddy KR, Beavers KL, Hammond SP, Lim JK, Falck-Ytter YT. American Gastroenterological Association Institute guideline on the prevention and treatment of hepatitis B virus reactivation during immunosuppressive drug therapy. *Gastroenterology*. Jan 2015;148(1):215-9; quiz e16-7. doi:10.1053/j.gastro.2014.10.039

Saeed YA, Phoon A, Bielecki JM, et al. A Systematic Review and Meta-Analysis of Health Utilities in Patients With Chronic Hepatitis C. *Value Health*. Jan 2020;23(1):127-137. doi:10.1016/j.jval.2019.07.005

Simmonds P. Reconstructing the origins of human hepatitis viruses. *Philosophical transactions of the Royal Society of London Series B, Biological sciences*. Jul 29 2001;356(1411):1013-26. doi:10.1098/rstb.2001.0890

Spach. Hepatitis C Diagnostic Testing. https://www.hepatitisc.uw.edu/go/screening-diagnosis/diagnostic-testing/core-concept/all

Su S, Wong WC, Zou Z, et al. Cost-effectiveness of universal screening for chronic hepatitis B virus infection in China: an economic evaluation. *Lancet Glob Health*. Feb 2022;10(2):e278-e287. doi:10.1016/s2214-109x(21)00517-9

Teo E-K, Lok ASF. Epidemiology, transmission, and prevention of hepatitis B virus infection. Updated Mar 20, 2025. https://www.uptodate.com/contents/epidemiology-transmission-and-prevention-of-hepatitis-b-virus-infection

Terrault NA, Lok ASF, McMahon BJ, et al. Update on prevention, diagnosis, and treatment of chronic hepatitis B: AASLD 2018 hepatitis B guidance. *Hepatology*. Apr 2018;67(4):1560-1599. doi:10.1002/hep.29800

Vetter BN, Reipold EI, Ongarello S, et al. Sensitivity and Specificity of Rapid Diagnostic Tests for Hepatitis C Virus With or Without HIV Coinfection: A Multicentre Laboratory Evaluation Study. *The Journal of Infectious Diseases*. 2022;doi:10.1093/infdis/jiaa389

Wandeler G, Schlauri M, Jaquier ME, et al. Incident Hepatitis C Virus Infections in the Swiss HIV Cohort Study: Changes in Treatment Uptake and Outcomes Between 1991 and 2013. *Open forum infectious diseases*. Jan 2015;2(1):ofv026. doi:10.1093/ofid/ofv026

WHO. Guidelines for the prevention, diagnosis, care and treatment for people with chronic hepatitis B infection. Updated March 29, 2024. https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789240090903

WHO. Hepatitis A. Updated February 12, 2025. https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/hepatitis-a

WHO. Hepatitis B. Updated April 2024. https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/hepatitis-b

WHO. Hepatitis C. Updated April 9, 2024. https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/hepatitis-c

WHO. Hepatitis D. Updated July 20, 2023. https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/hepatitis-d

WHO. Priorities in planning person-centred hepatitis B and C testing services: operational guide. Updated December 4, 2024. https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789240104082

WHO. Recommendations and guidance on hepatitis C virus self-testing. Updated July 15, 2021. https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789240031128

WHO. Updated recommendations on treatment of adolescents and children with chronic HCV infection, and HCV simplified service delivery and diagnostics. Updated October 2022. https://www.who.int/publications/i/item/9789240052734